Qianwen (Kaia) Gao

kaiagao@berkeley.edu | kaiagao.com | GitHub | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Interpretable AI agents, faithful explanations, language and memory, grounded reasoning, and human-guided embodied systems.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley 2025 - 2026
Master of Computational Social Science | GPA: 3.87/4.00

Zhejiang University 2021 - 2025
Bachelor of Arts, Communication | GPA: 3.95/4.00

PUBLICATION

CHASE: How Content Ecosystems Are Reshaped When Ranking Is the Only Target

Qianwen Gao, Zichang Su, Yiwen Hou, Arlen Kumar, Leanid Palkhouski. *Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*, 2026. Poster presentation. arXiv:2608.30466.

RESEARCH AND EVALUATION EXPERIENCE

Wrodium | AI Research Intern Dec 2025 - Jul 2026

Co-authored CHASE, a controlled simulation of how repeated optimization for LLM ranking signals changes content quality and ranking alignment across six domains.

Led FreshRAG benchmark development: constructed temporal QA data from factual changes and designed controlled experiments on knowledge conflict, temporal grounding, and parametric override.

APPA Health | Strategy and Data Analyst Intern Sep - Dec 2025

Developed a measurement framework for youth wellness programs and analyzed pre/post survey data to assess engagement and inform program changes.

SELECTED PROJECTS

PickMem | Independent project 2026

Built a local-first LLM memory-curation application with semantic retrieval, making stored context easier for users to inspect and manage.

Amazon Fashion Review Sentiment Analysis | Team course project 2025

Analyzed approximately 831,000 reviews with topic modeling and aspect-based sentiment analysis to identify themes and product attributes associated with ratings.

Chronic Absenteeism Prediction | ONGB and Wizearly capstone 2026

Evaluated early-warning models on Oakland student attendance data and examined precision-recall tradeoffs to support decisions about intervention thresholds.

METHODS AND TOOLS

Methods: LLM evaluation, NLP, retrieval-augmented generation, experimental design, causal inference, regression.
Programming and tools: Python, SQL, R, TypeScript; pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch, Git.